TRUSTMRR · SESSION 3 · SUBMISSION BY SNEHA GANESH

A Deep Dive into TrustMRR

What 1,000 self-reported startup ledgers tell us about categories, monetization patterns, and payment infrastructure.

1,000

companies tracked

29

data fields

FROZEN

30 Jul 2026

What data did we look at, and why?

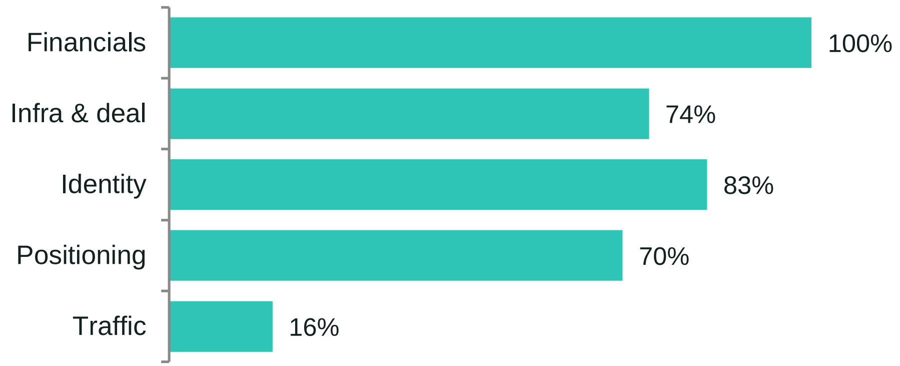
TrustMRR is a public ledger of revenue from indie and early-stage startups. Each row is one company, verified against a connected payment provider — giving us a rare, granular read on how small software businesses actually make money.

WHY THIS ANALYSIS

- Map the market: which categories and business models actually exist here
- Understand monetization: what makes a company here money-making vs. not
- Scan payment infrastructure: which gateways this market already runs on

DATA COMPLETENESS BY FIELD GROUP

% of 1,000 rows populated, averaged per group



Every company is priced and reports financials. Traffic data (visitors, revenue-per-visitor) is the thin spot — only 16% average completeness — so read those two fields as directional, not comprehensive.

The ledger at a glance

Across all 1,000 companies, before we split by category, country, or business model.

1,000

Companies tracked

65 countries · 29 categories

$13.47M

Total pooled MRR

$15.6M trailing 30-day revenue

$282

Median company MRR

mean is $13.5K — heavily skewed

80.3%

Companies monetized

803 report MRR above $0

64.9%

Run on Stripe

the default payment rail

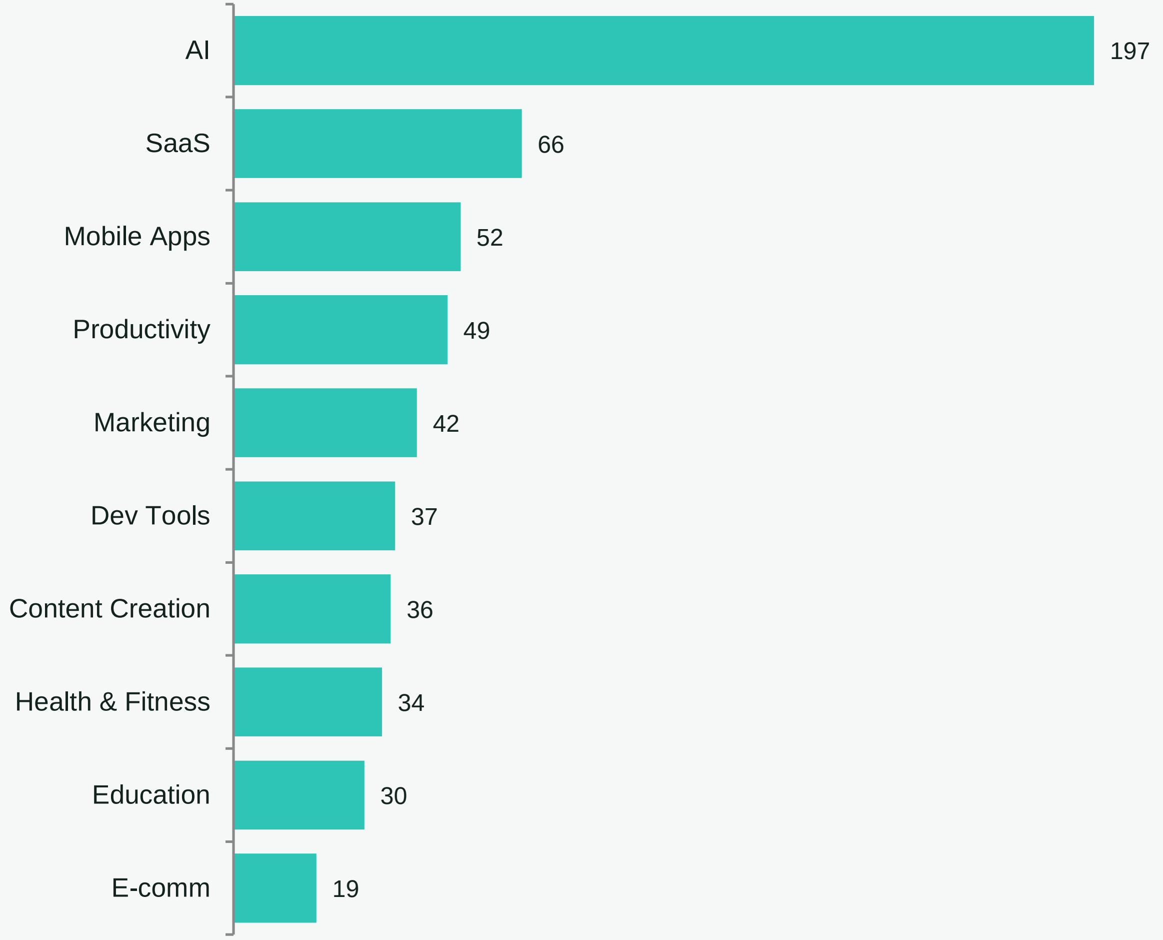
26.2%

Listed for sale

$86.8M combined asking price

29 categories exist — one dominates

TOP 10 OF 29 CATEGORIES SHOWN



AI is nearly 1 in 5

197 companies — 3x the next largest category (SaaS, 66).

Long tail beyond the top 10

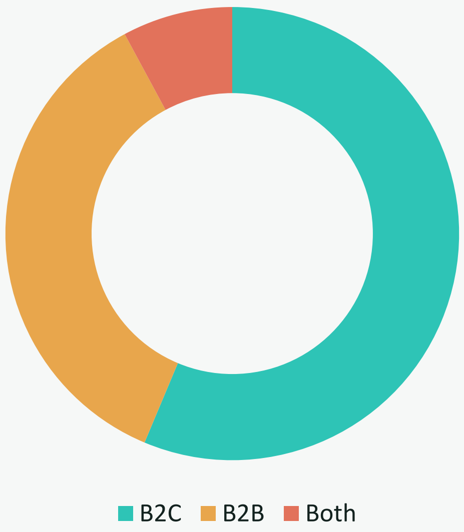
19 more categories exist, from Fintech (16) down to single-company niches like Legal and Crypto & Web3.

27.4% carry no tag

274 rows have no category — read leaderboards as a view of the ~73% tagged, not the full 1,000.

Who these companies are built for

AUDIENCE TYPE



401 B2C · 255 B2B · 56 both — 288 unspecified. A consumer-leaning, indie-hacker market.

WEBSITE & DOMAIN FOOTPRINT

86.2% — **have a live website URL on file**
862 of 1,000 rows

71.4% — **have a scoreable domain (Ahrefs-style rating)**
714 of 1,000 rows

10 — **median Domain Rating across all scored sites**
range 0–89

35 — **median Domain Rating among $10K+/mo earners**
3.5x the overall median — authority tracks revenue

Reading: a live, authoritative website isn't just a presence signal — the data shows a real correlation with revenue scale.

05 · MONETIZATION

What's actually monetizable here

1,000
companies tracked

862
have a live website

→

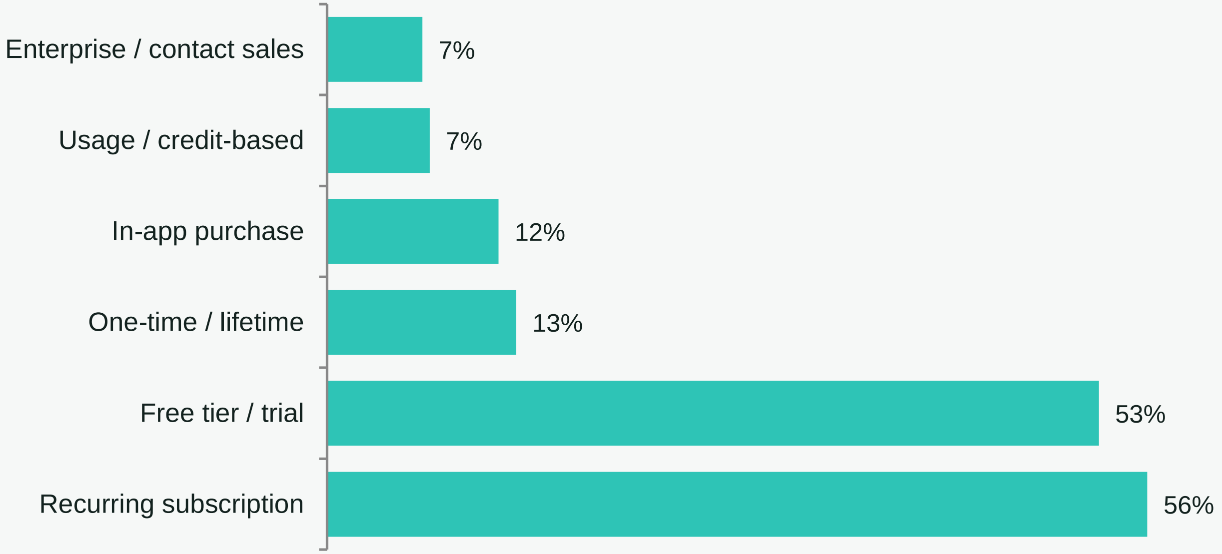
803
generate MRR above $0

→

212
have scaled past $10K/mo

From 1,000 tracked listings, 8 in 10 monetize at all — but only 1 in 5 has reached meaningful scale ($10K+/mo).

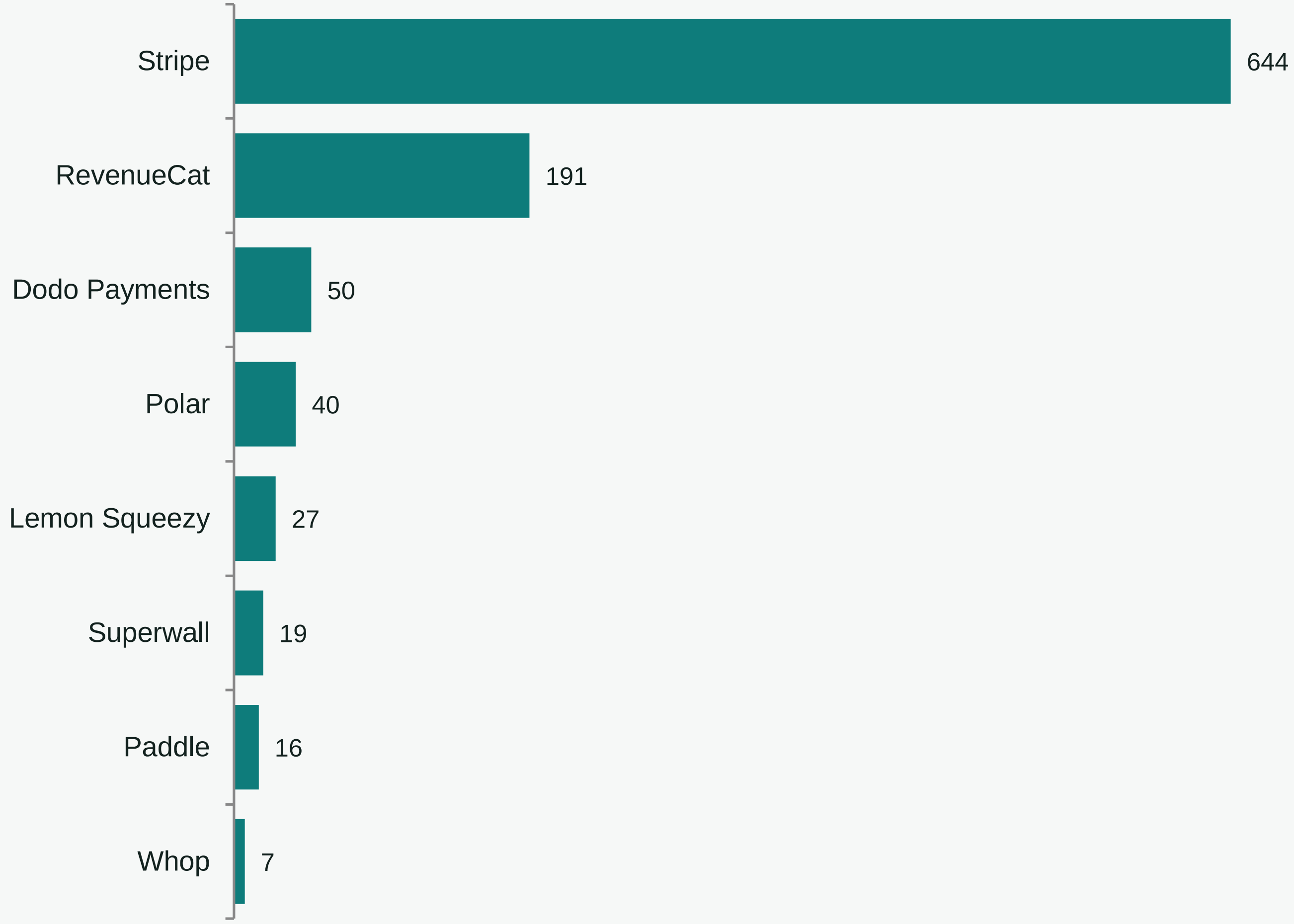
HOW THEY PRICE (of 657 rows with a stated model)



READING THE MODEL MIX

- Recurring subscription and a free tier are the two most common patterns — many companies run both at once (freemium-to-paid).
- Usage/credit-based pricing shows up almost entirely in the AI category — a monetization signature worth tracking as that category grows.
- 343 rows (34%) have no pricing model on file — likely pre-monetization or not yet publicly priced.

The payment gateway landscape



64.9%

of companies run on Stripe

By a wide margin the default rail — general-purpose card payments and subscriptions.

19.1%

run on RevenueCat

The #2 gateway, concentrated in mobile subscription apps (in-app purchase pricing).

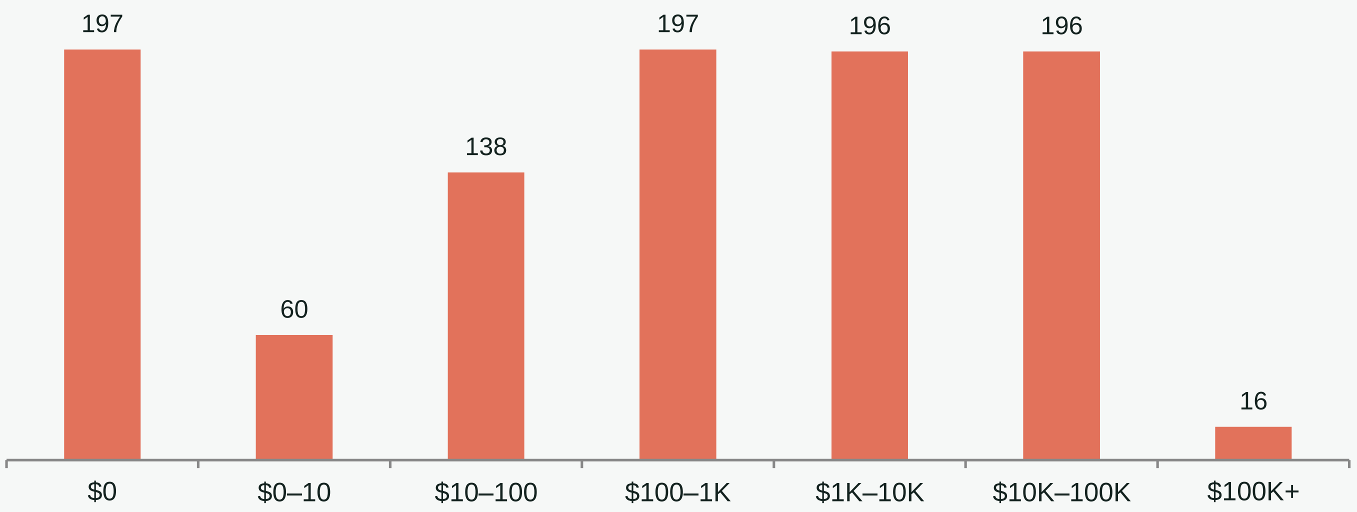
~4%

run more than one gateway

A small stacked-provider segment, often Stripe paired with a niche processor.

Revenue is a power law, not a bell curve

MRR distribution across all 1,000 companies (bucketed)



TOP 3 BY MRR

$3.57M
Stan
US

$494.7K
GojiberryAI
US · AI

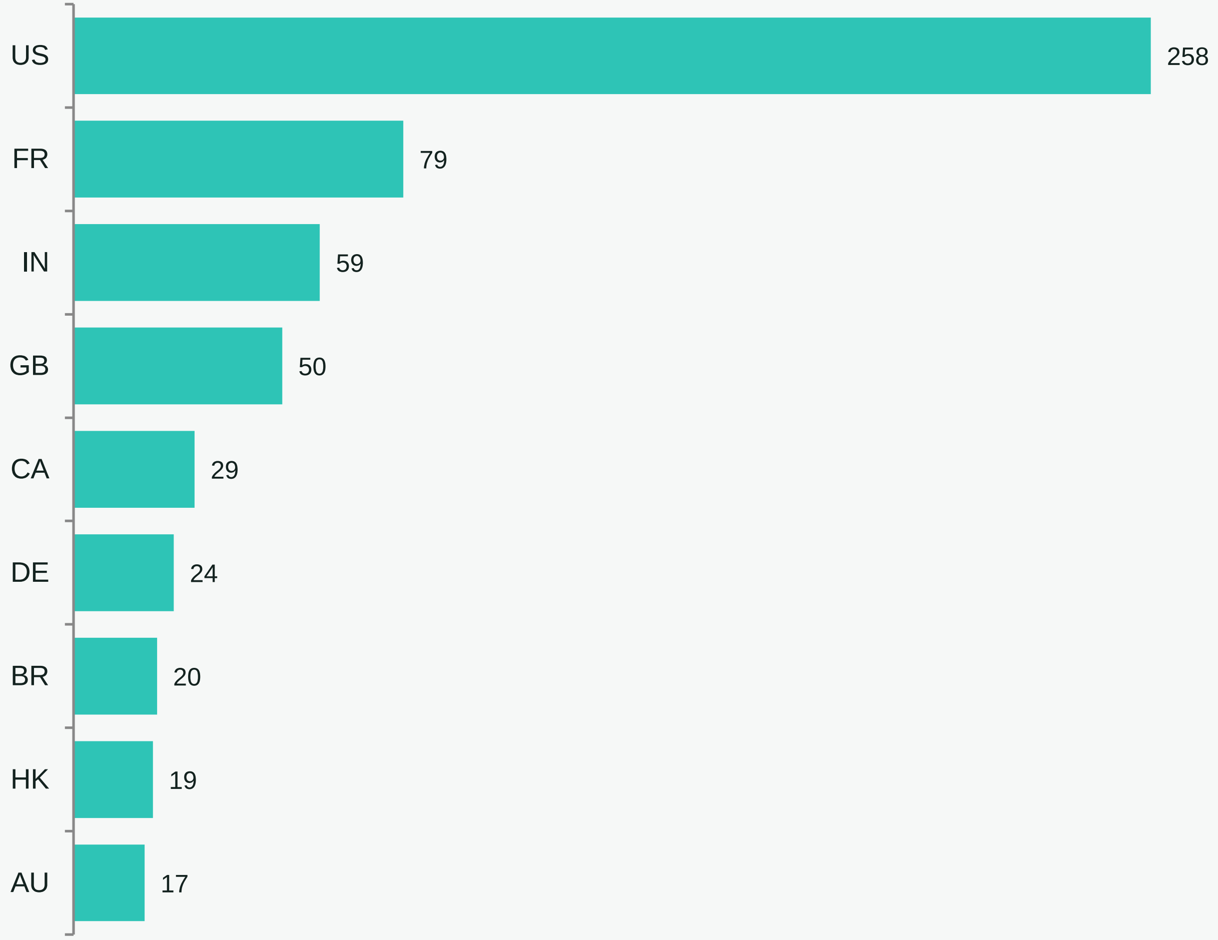
$259.7K
Rezi
US · AI

THE CONCENTRATION READ

- The single top company (Stan, $3.57M MRR) is 26.5% of the entire ecosystem's $13.47M pooled MRR — alone.
- Just 16 companies (1.6%) clear $100K/mo — that sliver drives the bulk of total value.
- The median company earns $282/mo — the true center of this market is small, pre-scale software businesses.
- For sourcing or benchmarking: aggregate averages will always be misleading here. Segment by scale tier, not by mean.

A US-anchored, globally long-tailed market

TOP 9 OF 65 COUNTRIES SHOWN



25.8% of companies, 55.7% of MRR

The US holds 258 companies but $7.5M of the $13.47M pooled MRR — outsized revenue share, not just headcount.

France and India lead the rest

79 and 59 companies respectively — but neither cracks the MRR top 3, pointing to earlier-stage cohorts.

241 rows have no country

24.1% of listings — treat the geographic split as a read on the ~76% that are tagged.

1 in 4 companies is already for sale

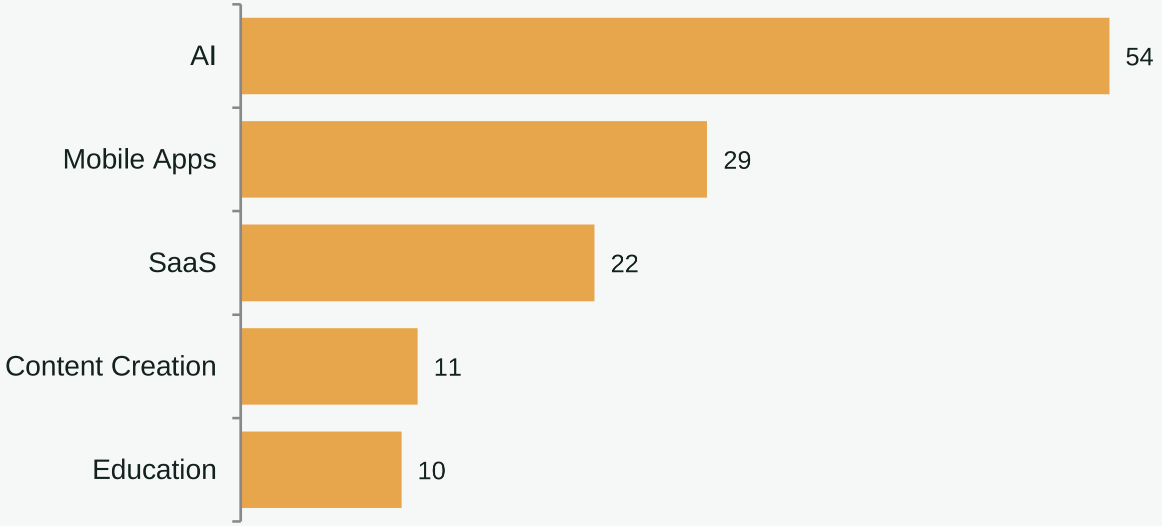
262
companies on sale
26.2% of all 1,000 listings

$86.8M
combined asking price
across those 262 listings

2.35x
median revenue multiple
of the 262 with a stated multiple

$35K
median asking price
half ask more, half ask less

MOST-LISTED CATEGORIES ON SALE



READING FOR A BUYER'S LENS

- AI leads on-sale listings by far (54) — mirrors its dominance in the overall category mix, not a distress signal.
- The median multiple (2.35x revenue) is modest next to the mean (~8x) — a handful of high-multiple outliers pull the average up.
- Multiples cluster low (25th pct ≈ 0.9x) — most listings here are small, early-revenue businesses, not proven scalers.

Reading the gaps honestly

Before acting on any of the above, four caveats worth carrying into the room.

27.4% / 24.1% untagged

Category and country are missing on roughly a quarter of rows — leaderboards reflect the tagged subset, not the full 1,000.

82.2% missing traffic data

visitors_30d is only populated for 178 companies — revenue-per-visitor comparisons are a thin, self-selected sample.

28.6% missing domain rating

SEO/authority comparisons rest on 714 of 1,000 rows — directionally useful, not exhaustive.

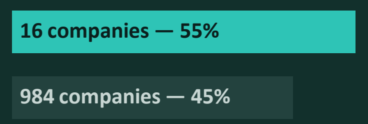
Anonymized top performers

Several "Stealth Company" listings sit near the top of the MRR leaderboard — rankings include masked identities we can't attribute.

What the data means for the business

Six patterns worth acting on, drawn from the full read of categories, monetization, infrastructure, geography, and the secondary market.

55% OF ALL MRR SITS WITH 1.6% OF COMPANIES



Segment by scale, not average

Mean MRR ($13.5K) is skewed by outliers; median is $282. Any benchmark, forecast, or eligibility filter needs a scale tier — not a blended figure.

AI is the center of gravity

197 companies, $1.8M pooled MRR, and the most on-sale listings (54) — the largest, most active, and most liquid segment to prioritize for sourcing or partnerships.

Freemium-to-paid is the default playbook

56% recurring subscription, 53% free tier, only 34% unpriced — expect a low-friction upgrade funnel when engaging companies in this market.

Stripe is the de facto rail

65% run on Stripe, RevenueCat covers most of the mobile-subscription remainder — any integration or diligence workflow should default to Stripe-first.

Revenue is more concentrated than headcount

The US holds 25.8% of companies but 55.7% of MRR — a blended global view understates how US-weighted outcomes really are.

A real, if early-stage, acquisition pool

262 companies for sale at a median 2.35x revenue — a viable sourcing channel for tuck-ins, though most listings are small and early-revenue, not proven scalers.

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEPS

- Segment benchmarks by MRR scale tier
- Prioritize an AI-category sourcing pipeline
- Assume Stripe-first for any integration
- Screen on-sale listings under 3x multiple